12 Ways to Make Money in One Hour (2026): Legit and Realistic Ways to Earn Fast Cash

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Quick Answer: The best ways to make money in one hour include using get-paid-to apps like Swagbucks and Branded Surveys, selling unused possessions on Facebook Marketplace, completing microtasks on Clickworker or Amazon Mechanical Turk, delivering food through DoorDash or Uber Eats, doing odd jobs on TaskRabbit, walking dogs through Rover, doing yard work for neighbours, recycling containers, finding unclaimed money through the Bank of Canada, selling unused gift cards on CardSwap.ca, and taking on quick freelance gigs. You can realistically earn anywhere from a few dollars to over $100 in a single hour, depending on the method and your effort level. The fastest ways to get cash typically involve selling items you already own or performing services like food delivery and dog walking.

Introduction: Fast Cash When You're Short on Time

Short on cash as well as time? When you need money in a hurry, you don't necessarily need to apply for a loan. There are plenty of legit ways to make fast cash, including online and offline options. Some methods are more lucrative than others, though, so keep reading to find out how to make money in an hour.

Whether you need gas money, grocery cash, or just a little extra spending money, there's a method on this list that fits your available time and resources. The key is understanding which options offer the best return for your effort and which ones can realistically be completed within a single hour.

Top Picks at a Glance

Play Games & Take Surveys

Freecash

$40 Reward

Access a variety of tasks

Make an average of $300 per offer

Get a $10 CAD sign-up bonus when you start your first offer

Best for Mobile

Testerup

Earn up to $800 through offers

No limit on how much you play games or complete surveys

Earn money while playing games

Paid Surveys

LEO (Leger Opinion)

Earn up to $100 per month in rewards

Finder readers receive 2,000 LEO welcome bonus points

Free, user-friendly, and secure app and website

1. *Use Get-Paid-To (GPT) Apps*

How much you can earn in one hour: Typically $0.50 to $5 per hour, up to $35 depending on tasks and engagement (but this isn't typical)

How it works: GPT apps like Branded Surveys and Swagbucks let you earn money by doing things like completing surveys, playing online and mobile games, and signing up for special offers. They won't make you rich, but they do provide a simple way for anyone to earn a little extra spending money online.

Tips to Succeed

Sign up for multiple GPT platforms to increase opportunities

Complete your profile thoroughly for better survey matches

Focus on higher-paying tasks when available

Cash out regularly to avoid points expiration

Use downtime (commute, waiting rooms) to maximize earning potential

1. *Sell Your Stuff*

How much you can earn in one hour: It depends on what you have to sell. You could potentially make tens or hundreds of dollars.

How it works: Offload your unused possessions for cash. If you've got stuff you no longer need or use cluttering up your home, head to your nearest pawn shop or consider listing items for sale on platforms like Facebook Marketplace.

Tips to Succeed

Take clear, well-lit photos from multiple angles

Write detailed descriptions including condition and dimensions

Price competitively by researching similar listings

Respond promptly to inquiries

Consider pawn shops for immediate cash if you need money right away

Related: Free, legitimate apps that pay real money instantly

1. *Microtasks*

How much you can earn in one hour: Approximately $0.50 - $15 per hour.

How it works: Clickworker, JumpTask and Amazon Mechanical Turk pay ordinary people like you to complete basic online tasks. Common jobs include audio transcription, data entry, tagging images and moderating content. In return for each completed task, you receive a small payment.

Tips to Succeed

Complete qualification tests to unlock higher-paying tasks

Focus on tasks from requesters with good ratings

Work efficiently to maximize earnings

Use scripts to automate repetitive tasks where allowed

Check for new tasks regularly

Don't Leave Money on the Table

40 ways to get 'free' money in Canada through rebates, bonuses and money strategies

Let's go

1. *Deliver Food*

How much you can earn in one hour: Approximately $20 – $25.

How it works: Sign up to deliver food with an app like DoorDash, Uber Eats and SkipTheDishes. If you've got a car, it's a quick and relatively easy way to make some extra money straight away.

Tips to Succeed

Work during peak meal times for higher earnings

Track your mileage for tax deductions

Keep your delivery bag clean and insulated

Provide friendly service for better tips

Consider multiple apps to maximize orders

1. *Do Odd Jobs*

How much you can earn in one hour: $10 – $100

How it works: Gig apps and websites like TaskRabbit and UrbanTasker are the perfect place to find work doing all sorts of odd jobs. There are plenty of people out there who are willing to pay you to do things like assemble flatpack furniture, wait in a queue for them, mount a TV, move a heavy piece of furniture, run errands or just do basic maintenance tasks around the house. If you're happy to work as a handyman or a sort of personal assistant, there are plenty of ways you can make money fast.

Tips to Succeed

Build a strong profile with reviews

Set competitive rates to attract initial clients

Be reliable and punctual

Bring your own tools for higher-paying jobs

Consider specializing in specific services

1. *Walk Dogs*

How much you can earn in one hour: Approximately $20 – $60 per hour.

How it works: Whether you use an app like Rover or just offer pet care services independently, dog walking is a simple but effective way to make cash fast. It's a service that's in high demand in major cities, and it also provides the potential to generate ongoing income from repeat bookings.

Tips to Succeed

Build trust through reviews and references

Get pet first aid certified

Take photos during walks to share with owners

Be reliable and communicate clearly

Consider offering additional services like pet sitting

1. *Do Yard Work*

How much you can earn in one hour: Approximately $20 – $50.

How it works: Go door-to-door in your neighbourhood offering to take care of basic yard work tasks for homeowners. You can mow lawns, trim edges, weed gardens, rake leaves, shovel snow and clear gutters, all for a decent hourly rate or price per job.

Tips to Succeed

Bring your own equipment for higher rates

Offer seasonal services like snow removal in winter

Be reliable and do quality work

Ask for referrals from satisfied customers

Consider monthly maintenance packages for recurring income

1. *Recycle Containers*

How much you can earn in one hour: You might only earn a couple of bucks if you're scrounging around for containers at home, but you could make $10 or more if you're willing to go dumpster diving.

How it works: Take advantage of the container recycling scheme or deposit-return system for beverage containers where you live. Recycle eligible containers to get paid for each item you recycle. While it won't make you rich, it's a legit way to earn a little extra cash.

Tips to Succeed

Know which containers are eligible in your province

Collect from neighbours, friends, and local events

Sort containers by type for faster processing

Check for special recycling events that pay higher rates

Consider regular collection routes for consistent income

1. *Find Unclaimed Money*

How much you can earn in one hour: Varies. You might get nothing, you might find some spare change, or you could make hundreds of dollars.

How it works: Maybe you have some money sitting untouched in a bank account you've forgotten about? The Bank of Canada's Unclaimed Property Office is responsible for holding unclaimed bank balances of less than $1,000 for 30 years, and unclaimed balances of $1,000 or more for 100 years. You can search for your unclaimed bank balances online. Alternatively, you might have been sent cheques from the CRA that you never got around to cashing. These cheques never expire, so see if there are any listed in the "Uncashed cheques" section of your CRA account.

Tips to Succeed

Search the Bank of Canada's unclaimed balances database

Check your CRA account for uncashed cheques

Contact former employers about unclaimed wages

Check with provincial unclaimed property offices

Set reminders to check periodically for new listings

1. *Sell Unused Gift Cards*

How much you can earn in one hour: From $10 to a few-hundred dollars.

How it works: If you've been given gift cards you don't want to use, sell them for cash on sites like CardSwap.ca. Instead of buying something you don't need from a retailer you don't shop at, get the money you need quickly.

Tips to Succeed

Check the card's balance before selling

Compare offers from multiple gift card exchange sites

Sell cards for popular retailers for higher returns

Keep the card information secure until the sale is complete

Consider trading with friends or family instead of selling at a discount

1. *Complete Quick Freelance Gigs*

How much you can earn in one hour: $15 – $75+ depending on your skills

How it works: If you have marketable skills like writing, graphic design, translation, or programming, you can pick up quick freelance gigs on platforms like Fiverr and Upwork. Many clients need small tasks completed urgently—like proofreading a document, designing a social media graphic, or translating a short text. These micro-gigs can often be completed within an hour and paid upon delivery.

Tips to Succeed

Create a profile highlighting your fastest-delivery services

Offer "express" or "rush" options for premium rates

Focus on tasks you can complete quickly and well

Build reviews by delivering excellent work on time

Use ChatGPT or other AI tools to speed up your workflow

1. *Participate in Paid Research Studies*

How much you can earn in one hour: $20 – $100+ per study

How it works: Market research companies and universities frequently run paid research studies that take an hour or less to complete. These can be online surveys, focus groups, usability tests, or academic studies. Platforms like UserTesting, Respondent, and local university research boards regularly post opportunities. While availability varies, when you qualify, the pay is often excellent for the time required.

Tips to Succeed

Sign up with multiple research platforms

Complete your demographic profile thoroughly

Check for new studies regularly

Be honest and engaged during sessions

Follow up on payment if delayed

What Are the Best Ways to Make Money in One Hour?

It depends on whether your definition of "best" means the easiest, the most lucrative, or the one most likely to succeed.

In theory, selling unwanted possessions can potentially net you hundreds of dollars. But if you can't find a buyer, or if you simply don't have anything to sell, you might not make a cent.

In terms of simplicity, it's hard to go past GPT apps. You can get paid just to sit on your couch at home playing games and answering surveys. But the payouts are small, so it's not going to make you rich.

In terms of getting money fast—and potentially finding an ongoing source of income—odd jobs, yard work and dog walking may offer the best way to make money in one hour.

Comparison of One-Hour Money-Making Methods

Method	*Earning Potential*	*Effort Level*	*Best For*
GPT Apps	*$0.50 - $5*	*Low*	*Anyone with a smartphone*
Selling Stuff	*$10 - $100+*	*Medium*	*People with unused items*
Microtasks	*$0.50 - $15*	*Low*	*Detail-oriented people*

Food Delivery	*$20 - $25*	*Medium*	*People with vehicles*
Odd Jobs	*$10 - $100*	*Medium-High*	*Handy people*
Dog Walking	*$20 - $60*	*Medium*	*Animal lovers*
Yard Work	*$20 - $50*	*Medium-High*	*Physically fit people*
Recycling Containers	*$2 - $10+*	*Medium*	*Environmentally conscious*
Unclaimed Money	*$0 - $100+*	*Low*	*Anyone*
Selling Gift Cards	*$10 - $300+*	*Low*	*People with unused cards*
Freelance Gigs	*$15 - $75+*	*Medium-High*	*Skilled professionals*
Research Studies	*$20 - $100+*	*Low-Medium*	*Anyone who qualifies*

What to Watch Out For

Any offer that sounds too good to be true. Be wary of "job ads" on social media that claim to offer ways for you to get rich quick by working from home. There are plenty of scams out there that will require you to make an upfront payment or hand over your personal information, but then won't provide you with any employment when you do.

Microtask scams. Scammers target innocent people through WhatsApp and other social media platforms. They typically offer small payouts when you perform simple microtasks, but then require you to deposit money to access higher-paying jobs.

Payday loans. A payday loan is a short-term loan of up to $1,500 that is typically designed to be paid back by your next payday. They're also very expensive, and their short repayment terms put you at risk of being trapped in a cycle of debt. Payday loans should only ever be considered as a last resort.

Loan scams. Predatory lenders target people who are experiencing financial hardship. If you're thinking about borrowing money, make sure you know how to spot the red flags that could indicate a personal loan scam.

Red Flags to Watch For

Payment required upfront to access work

Requests for sensitive personal or financial information

Guaranteed high earnings with no effort

Pressure to act immediately

No verifiable company information

Requests to deposit money to unlock higher pay

Dive deeper: Best payday loans and cash advances in Canada

Bottom Line

If you're strapped for cash as well as time, there are plenty of ways you can make extra money in a hurry. Some might net you a few extra bucks, while others could potentially turn into a decent source of ongoing income. So if you need to make money in one hour, compare your earning options and get to work.

The key is to match the method to your available resources—whether that's unused items to sell, skills to offer, a vehicle for delivery, or simply time to complete surveys. Even if you only earn a small amount in one hour, establishing these habits can lead to more significant income over time.

Frequently Asked Questions

How can I make $100 in one hour?

Making $100 in a single hour is possible but requires either valuable items to sell, in-demand skills, or willingness to do physical work. The most realistic options include selling unused electronics or furniture

on Facebook Marketplace (if you have items worth $100+), completing a high-paying research study or focus group, picking up an urgent freelance gig, or doing multiple odd jobs through TaskRabbit. Dog walking and yard work can also add up quickly if you secure multiple clients in your neighbourhood.

How do I make immediate cash?

For truly immediate cash, the fastest options are selling items to a pawn shop, recycling containers at a depot, or selling unused gift cards on CardSwap.ca. Food delivery apps like DoorDash and Uber Eats pay out quickly, sometimes within hours or days depending on your bank. GPT apps and survey sites often have minimum withdrawal thresholds, so they're less useful for immediate cash needs unless you've already accumulated earnings.

Can I use ChatGPT to make money?

Yes, you can use ChatGPT to make money, but it works best as a tool to enhance your existing skills rather than a standalone income source. You can use it to speed up freelance writing, generate ideas for digital products, create social media content for clients, or assist with transcription and translation work. The key is combining ChatGPT's speed with your own expertise and quality control—clients pay for results, not for AI output alone.

Are there any ways to get free money in Canada?

There are legitimate ways to get "free" money in Canada, though most require some effort. You can search for unclaimed bank balances through the Bank of Canada, check your CRA account for uncashed cheques, take advantage of bank sign-up bonuses, use cashback websites for purchases you'd make anyway, and claim referral bonuses from various apps and services. These aren't truly "free"—they require some action on your part—but they represent money you're entitled to or can earn with minimal effort.

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